

WORKING DRAFT · V0.4-BETA · 2026-06-27

Reconnecta

*A regenerative living laboratory at
Óbidos Lagoon, Portugal.*

Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.

— NORBERT ROZTOCKI, FOUNDER

LOCATION

LAND

PROGRAMME

STAGE

OWNER

FOUNDER

Nadadouro, Portugal 4.83 ha (3 parcels) Hotel Rural 3★ · 10 units PIP submitted HOME 4 LIFE LDA [Norbert Roztocki](#)

Executive Summary

Reconnecta is a 4.83-hectare regenerative project under development on the western coast of Portugal, between Óbidos Lagoon and the Atlantic. Its purpose is to prove — at human scale and on a single piece of land — that uncompromising ecological practice and uncompromising quality of life are not opposites. They are the same craft, done well.

The project is organised around three interlocking commitments: a family home, a working ecosystem, and a place where others learn what it took to build it. The hospitality layer — a 10-unit Hotel Rural 3★, currently in the Portuguese pre-permit (PIP) stage — funds the operation. Workshops, residencies and a research programme give it meaning. The land itself — soils, water, oaks, horses, food — is both medium and message.

Reconnecta is being built by Norbert Roztocki and family, with Paweł Sroczyński as project manager. It is not a retreat centre, not a commune, not a brand. It is a place.

This document describes what is known, what is being designed, and what remains to be answered. Open questions are flagged in line as **PENDING — ...** and registered in §19 so they can be tracked rather than hidden.

Project Roadmap

Reconnecta is being delivered as a seven-stage process. **Stage 0 is being finalised now** — this whitepaper, the gap registry in §19 and the Regrarians basemap in the public source repository are its outputs. Everything from Stage 1 onward is ahead of us.

#	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	STATUS
0	Holistic Context	Organise everything we know about the place, the people, the constraints and the goals into a single artefact.	IN PROGRESS · FINALISING
1	Conceptual Work	Translate the holistic context into spatial form. First sketches that turn values and constraints into proposed shape on the land.	PENDING
2	Integral Conceptual Sketch	Working architectural and functional form, plus team-building. The shape becomes a working design proposition.	PENDING

#	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	STATUS
3	Technical Conceptual Project	Engineering layer added to the design — structure, systems, materials decisions.	PENDING
4	Construction Documentation	Full building permit and execution drawings.	PENDING
5	Phased Construction	Building. Phased to align with permits, weather, capital cycles.	PENDING
6	Living	Occupancy. The land is in use.	PENDING

The stages are sequential — each one consumes the output of the previous. The current document closes Stage 0 by making the project legible to itself and to anyone joining it.

§ 03

The Holistic Goal

Every design decision in this project is tested against a single sentence — the day Norbert wants this place to make possible:

Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.

Behind that sentence sit three pillars:

QUALITY OF LIFE

Family home. Horses. Creativity. Guests. Community. Nature immersion. Freedom from dependency on external systems.

FORMS OF PRODUCTION

Accommodation revenue. Horsemanship workshops. Ecology and permaculture workshops. Food from the land. Energy from the land. Artist residencies and cultural programming.

FUTURE RESOURCE BASE

Self-sustaining land in 50–100 years. Healthy soil. Biodiverse native ecosystem. A model others can learn from and replicate.

The Holistic Goal is the constitution; everything that follows is implementation.

§ 04

Site & Topography

Location	Nadadouro, Caldas da Rainha municipality
From Óbidos Lagoon	~1,000 m
From Atlantic	~3,000 m
Owned area	4.83 ha across 3 parcels (4.02 + 1.56 + 0.94 ha)
Owner	HOME 4 LIFE LDA · acquired 2019-02-04
Cadastral artigos	3978, 3988, 3994
Adjacent rented	4–5 ha · terms PENDING — see §19, Q20
Total operational	up to 8–10 ha
Zoning	PDM — Espaço Agro-Florestal
Planning framework	Agrotourism DL 39/2008 · Article 61 PDM · accommodation cap ≤ 600 m ² ABC
Topographic survey	TPG Lda (Pedro Agapito), 1:500 scale

Two zones

Upper section (~2 ha). Cleared ex-eucalyptus plantation. Heights 27–37 m. Average gradient ~5% over 200 m horizontal, slope facing south-west — warm, afternoon sun. The planned building zone. Soil is post-eucalyptus: degraded, clay/sand mix, compacted.

Lower section (~2 ha). Biodiverse, established native vegetation (oak, pine, local species). Heights 24–27 m. A seasonal stream runs through it. The PIP documents identify *zonas húmidas* (wetland zones) and multiple *linhas de água*. High ecological value, designated *preserve and enhance*.

Drainage. Upper section drains south-west toward the lower section's stream. Mediterranean–Atlantic hydrology: wet winters, dry summers. This is a design problem — capture, slow, store, distribute — not a resource problem.

Maps & access

PIP submission package includes cadastral plans, topographic survey, satellite aerial overlay, architectural site plans, full N-S and W-E cross-sections. Primary entry: east, from Travessa da Avé Maria. A second entry on the lower section is planned for horse and agricultural traffic, separating guest flows from operational flows.

§ 05

Land History

The land was acquired by HOME 4 LIFE LDA in February 2019 and has been in planning since. What sits on it now is the surface of a much longer story — the BioPiscinas landscape-planning study reads the place across three time-scales (Schwarzer & Schwarzer, *Landschaftsplanerische Bewertung — Abschlussbericht*, June 2026 · EN translation · DE original).

Pre-modern

Systematic deforestation under Roman and Moorish settlement; from the 19th to mid-20th century, intensive viticulture, orchards and small-parcel polyculture shaped the regional mosaic that is still legible today.

Industrial-era trace

The Nadadouro basin saw **brown-coal (lignite) mining** through the 19th and early 20th century, peaking around the World Wars and abandoned c. 1945 ("*abandono das minas, c. 1945,*" per the Portuguese síntese executiva). A 1959 geological map already lists the mine as decommissioned. The artificial drainage ditch that runs through the parcel today is hypothesised by BioPiscinas to date from this mining era — dewatering the natural depression at the foot of the eucalyptus plot. "*Oberflächlich kaum noch etwas zu sehen,*" the report notes — but atypical depressions remain in the topography, and the ditch shapes the hydrology to this day (see §8).

The last twenty years on this parcel

Aerial-photo time-series cited in the BioPiscinas study:

YEAR	DOMINANT COVER
2006	Forestry plantations dominate
2018	Sand-fields / freshly growing eucalyptus on the SE plot
2022	Heath species (<i>Ulex europaeus latebracteatus</i>) dominate northern plots

YEAR	DOMINANT COVER
2023	Planted forestry trees becoming dominant again

The report flags that *"intensive Eingriffe wie Baumpflanzungen und Fällen der Bäume sowie Umackern des Bodens"* — repeated planting, felling and ploughing within a 20-year window — has consequences for both biodiversity and the water balance of the place.

Current state at fieldwork (April 2026)

The eucalyptus stand has already been cut. Small native oaks and cork oaks are regenerating on the N/NW slope. The understorey of the eastern oak grove was recently cut as a fire-prevention action — BioPiscinas flags this as counter-productive (cleared dry undergrowth propagates fire faster than structured moist undergrowth; see §7).

The constant

"Einzig konstantes Element in der Landschaft ist der naturnahe Waldbestand auf dem Grundstück am Ostrand" — across all four aerial epochs, the only stable feature is the near-natural oak forest on the eastern edge of the parcel. That stand is the project's deepest ecological asset.

OPEN

- Q15 — Exact date of the eucalyptus felling (between 2018 and 2023, not yet pinned) and whether stumps were chemically treated.
- Q29 — Who held the land before HOME 4 LIFE LDA (2019); who planted the 2006 forestry stand.

§ 06

People & Decisions

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Investor & strategic owner	Norbert Roztocki	Active
Project manager	Paweł Sroczyński	Active · PENDING — Q8 formal scope
Architect	João Carlos Fonseca Jorge (OA #18423)	Engaged

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Topographic surveyor	TPG Lda	Engaged
Biologist	Engaged	Survey in progress
Operational manager	—	VACANT · PENDING — Q9 critical hire
Family	Kamila + two children (12, 14)	Roles partial · PENDING — Q7

Norbert

Investor, kitesurfer, natural-horsemanship practitioner. Holds final strategic and financial authority. Present 6–8 months per year — strongest in the shoulder seasons (February–May, September–November). Away during winter and peak summer. Currently committing about 12 hours per week to project planning.

Kamila (Camille)

Named *Camille* on the BioPiscinas study cover and *camilla* on the same study's plan captions. Spouse, partner, parent — and co-commissioner of the June 2026 landscape-planning study alongside Norbert. The signature on external studies makes her a documented co-decision-maker on the project's design-side. Day-to-day operational role during Norbert's absences — and whether she will be on-site — **PENDING — Q7**.

The vacancy that runs the place

A multi-enterprise operation (hospitality + horses + agriculture + workshops) requires presence 365 days a year. The brief: bilingual (Portuguese plus English/Polish), competent across horses, agriculture and hospitality. This person does not yet exist in the org. Recruitment in rural Portugal for this profile is itself a project. **PENDING — Q9, Q10**

Succession

Two paths held open: the children take over in time, or independent professional leadership succeeds the founder. Decided later, not now.

§ 07

Climate

Climate frame for the parcel (Schwarzer & Schwarzer, June 2026):

PARAMETER	VALUE
Köppen classification	Csb — Mediterranean, dry-cool summers, Atlantic
Annual precipitation	694 mm
Mean annual temperature	~21 °C
Cold-month night average	7 °C
Warm-month night average	17 °C
Highest recorded	39 °C (September 2016)
Lowest recorded	8 °C (February 2016)
Frost	"Frost ist selten" — rare
Wind	"weht oft sehr kräftig" — often strong; direction unspecified
Dry season	> 3 months in summer; evaporation exceeds precipitation

Fire risk — counter-intuitive finding

The BioPiscinas report contains a specific warning relevant to the parcel: clearing the understorey of the eastern oak grove, done as a "fire-prevention" measure before fieldwork, *"führt genau zum Gegenteil von dem, was mit der Aktion gemeint war, zu mehr Feuergefahr"* — leads to *more* fire risk, not less. Dry, exposed fuel propagates fire faster than structured moist undergrowth. This is consequential for any future fire plan, and contradicts the intuitive but mistaken practice common in the region.

STILL OPEN

- Q4 — Frost-day count per year (only "rare" so far)
- Q5 — Prevailing wind direction and peak speeds
- Q6 — PMDFCI fire-risk classification for this parcel + wildfire history within ~5 km

§ 08

Water

The watercourse that runs across the parcel is a **centuries-old artificial drainage ditch** dewatering a natural depression at the foot of the eucalyptus plot — *"die auf dem Grundstück vorhandene Senke war*

einst ein See oder ein Sumpfgebiet." Without the ditch the depression would have no outflow. The constitutional question for the project is therefore whether to keep dewatering or restore the lake.

What the site is

SOURCE	STATUS	NOTES
Municipal mains	Available	Reliable year-round; PIP confirms connection. Connection obligation likely applies for tourist-grade potable use
Rainwater storage	Planned	Buffer + capture
Artificial drainage ditch	Existing, anthropogenic	Centuries old. Cuts through the oak hill, dewateres the depression. Possibly mining-era (see §5)
Natural depression / former lake	Latent	Former lake/swamp at the foot of the eucalyptus plot. Shallow groundwater near surface year-round
Borehole	Planned	High-quality drinking water · APA licence PENDING — Q12 · hydrogeology warning below
Plant-based wastewater treatment	Recommended (BioPiscinas)	Pflanzenkläranlagen — reused on tree cultivation

What the field signals confirm

- **Indicator species.** *Potamogeton polygonifolius* (a perennial wetland species) is present in the south-western ditch. "*Diese Art kann auf Dauer nur in naturnahen Feuchtgebieten gedeihen*" — it can only persist where high groundwater is permanent.
- **Aerial-photo evidence.** Bright green vegetation in the southern depression visible in **September 2018** and **July 2022** — both deep into the dry season — confirms that near-surface water persists year-round, not just in wet winters. Partial answer to Q13: the depression doesn't go fully dry; the ditch's own summer flow is still unconfirmed.

The water concept — six pillars

The BioPiscinas *Wasserkonzept* organises every drop on and off the parcel around six sources of supply, each with its own constraints:

1. **Forest as water infrastructure.** Standing woodland is itself a water-generating, water-storing system. Preserve, manage, and where possible expand the forested zones — the cheapest infrastructure on the property.

2. **On-parcel retention.** Keep as much water on site as possible — this is the lever that everything else rests on (see also §10, intervention #3).
3. **Municipal mains.** Reliable, year-round. *Anschlusszwang* (mandatory connection) likely applies for tourist-use potable water; confirm with the câmara before any drilling decisions.
4. **Existing wells + a new shallow well.** Shallow wells are typically less mineralised than deep ones. Quality-test what is already on or adjacent to the parcel; site any new shallow well through an experienced hydrogeologist.
5. **Deep well (*Tiefbrunnen*)** — only after a hydrogeological opinion. The parcel sits on the **Caldas thermal region** (Caldas da Rainha basin = salt-dome subsidence basin formed by the Dagorda Formation). Exploration drillings between Nadadouro and Foz do Arelho document NaCl-bearing mesothermal water at 22–28 °C; hottest layers > 500–800 m deep. Deep wells here are likely to strike highly mineralised, probably non-potable water. The PDM of Caldas da Rainha lists Nadadouro–Foz do Arelho as a *zone with hydrothermal potential*. Any deep drilling requires DGEG (*Direção-Geral de Energia e Geologia*) authorisation.
6. **Rainwater harvest** — sized to the buildings on the architectural plan:

SURFACE	AREA
Main building (Hauptgebäude)	608 m ²
Five cabins (5 × 31 m ²)	155 m ²
Three greenhouses (135 + 68 + 96 m ²)	299 m ²
Total catchment	1,062 m²

Annual catch up to ~670 m³/year, capturable September–May. Decentralised storage is feasible because the buildings sit at different elevations.

Treated wastewater — sized worked example

Plant-based wastewater treatment (*Pflanzenkläranlagen*) is the reuse pillar. The report's *Rechenbeispiel* (worked example) parametrises a Hotel Rural at 20 rooms × 50 % occupancy × 360 l/day/guest = 7,200 l/day raw → 3,600 l/day treated → 112 m³/month → ~1,344 m³/year of irrigation-grade water. (Reconciliation needed against the architectural programme — see §10.

PENDING — 10 units (§10) vs 20 rooms (§8) reconciliation .)

Treated wastewater is delivered subsurface only, with a minimum setback of 50 m from any potable-water source (existing wells, new shallow wells, planned borehole).

Restoring the wetland — intervention proposed in §10

Lowering the historic dewatering ditch's effective base level (a weir) and partial undoing of centuries of drainage is described as the central design move for the parcel. It belongs to §10 Architecture as zone #3, with permits from the environmental agency required.

STILL OPEN

- **Water demand.** No formal demand calculation yet. Needs livestock numbers, irrigated areas, accommodation capacity. Downstream of **PENDING — Q16, Q17**
- **APA borehole licence.** Application not yet initiated. **PENDING — Q12**
- **Decision needed.** Restore the depression to a wetland (close or weir the ditch) or maintain the dewatering and design the lower section as drained pasture? This is a constitutional question for the project.

§ 09

Soil & Ecosystems

The soil and vegetation of the parcel are read here through Natura 2000 habitat codes (Schwarzer & Schwarzer, *Landschaftsplanerische Bewertung — Abschlussbericht*, June 2026).

Two-zone geological / soil model

ZONE	SUBSTRATE	POTENTIAL NATURAL VEGETATION	NATURA 2000
Eastern hill (eastern oak plot + part of the eucalyptus plot)	Dagorda marl, limestone, clay, dolomite — basic soils	Portuguese oak (Quercus faginea) forest	9240 — Iberian <i>Q. faginea</i> / <i>Q. canariensis</i> forests
Valley plots (lower section, north and south)	Plio-Pleistocene sands, sandstones, gravels — Astian Complex (Nadadouro / Águas Santas) — acidophilic, podzolised	Cork oak (Quercus suber) forest	9330 — small remnant sehr kleinflächig am Südrand (southern edge); rest of the valley is 4030 / 4030pt3 dry/ Atlantic gorse heath, the degradation stage

The lower section's dominant cover is *Ulex europaeus latebracteatus* gorse heath — the degradation stage that follows cork-oak loss; a small cork-oak remnant survives at the southern edge. The well-preserved oak stand on the *eastern hill* is *Quercus faginea* (with *Quercus × coutinhoi* hybrid and *Q.*

pseudococcifera in the same canopy) — a regionally rare, Natura-2000-listed habitat of significant conservation value. On damp lee slopes the same series can regress / refuge into ***5230 *Laurus nobilis* laurel forest** — a Natura 2000 *priority* habitat preserving palaeo-subtropical / Tertiary flora (*Prunus lusitanica*, *Myrica faya*).

Habitats inventoried by BioPiscinas

CODE	HABITAT	WHERE ON PARCEL
9240	Iberian <i>Quercus faginea</i> / <i>Q. canariensis</i> forests	Eastern oak hill (with <i>Q. × coutinhoi</i> hybrid + <i>Q. pseudococcifera</i>)
9330	<i>Quercus suber</i> cork-oak forest	Small remnant at southern edge of the valley
*5230 (priority)	<i>Laurus nobilis</i> laurel forest — palaeo-subtropical relict	Regression / refuge stage of the <i>Q. faginea</i> series on damp lee slopes
6410pt4	Portugal-endemic rush meadows with <i>Juncus valvatus</i> — relict	Wetland fringe (peripheral)
6430pt2	Perennial hygrophilic tall-herb vegetation on permanently moist soils	Wetland fringe
4030 / 4030pt3	Dry European / Atlantic gorse heaths	Dominant in valley plots — degradation stage of the <i>Q. suber</i> series

Red-List and notable flora

- *Carduus lusitanicus broteroi* (Least Concern)
- *Cheirolophus uliginosus* (Near Threatened) — peat-bog indicator
- *Quercus extremadurensis* — RELAPE-listed (Portuguese protected species)
- ~95 vascular plant species inventoried in the BioPiscinas vegetation survey

Confirmed invasives — small populations, eradicate now

- *Acacia* spec.
- *Carpobrotus edulis*
- *Conyza* spec.
- *Cortaderia sellowiana*

BioPiscinas urges **immediate eradication** while populations remain localised — a window that closes fast on this kind of substrate.

Ecological connectivity

The parcel sits in the **Lagoa de Óbidos catchment landscape**, a RAMSAR-protected wetland since early 2025. The eastern *Q. faginea* hill is therefore not just a local asset — it is a regionally rare, Natura-2000-listed habitat in a Ramsar-grade landscape. Whatever is built here lives next to that ecosystem.

The Portuguese síntese executiva of the report sets the strategic frame for municipal and environmental authorities as **três pilares: gestão hídrica, renaturalização e criação de cavalos** — water management, rewilding, horse husbandry.

SOIL CHEMISTRY & FAUNA — STILL OPEN

The BioPiscinas study works from lithological inference, not laboratory analysis. **No formal soil tests** (pH, organic matter, NPK, heavy metals, compaction) have been done on the parcel. The PIP's declaration that the agricultural area is livre de contaminação química is a legal statement, not a lab result.

- Q14 — Soil-test campaign with committed timeline. Required before any food-bearing planting.
- Fauna survey (birds, reptiles, amphibians, invertebrates) is still missing — BioPiscinas covered flora and habitat only.
- *Juncus valvatus* (the Portuguese endemic for habitat 6410pt4) was not yet documented on-parcel; a targeted survey could change the habitat status.

§ 10

Architecture & Buildings

Programme (per PIP)

Hotel Rural 3★ — formal classification under Portuguese rural-tourism law. Ten units total, built across a main building and two secondary buildings.

Main building	Ground + 1st floor — 7 double rooms with private bathrooms
Secondary building A	Additional units
Secondary building B	Additional units
Total ABC (tourist)	600 m ² (legal max under Article 61 PDM)
Building footprint	560 m ²

Basement	Covered guest parking, breakfast room, staff areas, technical installations
Roof	Green roof (confirmed in PIP plans)

In addition: family home, stables, atelier/workshop complex, and ancillary outbuildings — see §20.

Status

- **Architect:** João Carlos Fonseca Jorge, OA #18423 (Serra d'El-Rei). Professional indemnity confirmed (Ageas Portugal, policy #008410215055, €50k cover).
 - **Submission:** PIP submitted to Caldas da Rainha Câmara Municipal, January 2026.
 - **Stage:** Pre-permit information request. Awaiting municipal response.
 - **Risk:** Critical-path gate for construction. Rural Portuguese cycles run 6–18 months.
- PENDING — Q28** — contingency plan for 12-month delay.

Design principles

All buildings designed for **off-grid operation from day one**, with grid available as backup. Passive design first; technical systems sized to a load that has not yet been calculated (§10). Materials and detail follow the visual language collected on the Miro reference board (§13).

Eight-zone development plan

The BioPiscinas final report maps the parcel into eight numbered land-use zones tied to the project's goals. Together they form the spatial constitution that §8, §9, §11 and §12 implement in detail:

#	ZONE	PURPOSE
1	Bebauungsflächen Hotel Rural + Apoio agro-florestal	On the ex-eucalyptus stand at the forest edge, where the architectural project already proposes. Naturnahe gardens, permeable surfaces, Gründächer (green roofs) where possible, Schwimmteich (swim-pond), full grey- and black-water concept. Build around the natural sapling regeneration already begun on the slope — keep the trees that have re-emerged for shade.
2	Erweiterungsfläche	South of zone 1. Too steep for dry pasture, reserved for a building expansion shown on the architectural plan.
3	Reduce drainage outflow	Modify the level of the historic dewatering ditch (a weir), raise the on-parcel water table, partially undo centuries of dewatering. Requires environmental-agency permits.

#	ZONE	PURPOSE
4	Gewässer anlegen (create water bodies)	Open the eastern edge of the central wet depression to create an irrigation pond. Dig a small horse-trough pool at the dry/wet pasture transition on the west. Permits required.
5	Nutzgarten (kitchen garden)	Site the fruit and vegetable production on the groundwater-near soils in the valley along the ditch (fresh, nutrient-rich, well-watered → minimum irrigation). See §13.
6	Waldflächen (forest areas)	The second-largest area. Near-natural, ecologically the most valuable parts of the parcel. Preserve.
7 + 8	Pferdeweiden (horse pastures)	The largest share. Three sub-types: dry pasture, wet pasture, and a degraded northern zone overgrown with gorse, Cortaderia and Acacia. South-edge willow planting as visual screen to neighbours. See §12.

The overall framing: "*naturnahe, standortgerechte ökologische Prozesse ... aus denen der Mensch Vorteile zieht*" — near-natural, site-appropriate ecological processes from which humans draw benefits — with some sub-areas left fully to nature.

Programme reconciliation — open

The architectural programme cited above gives **10 units** under the Hotel Rural 3★ cap (Article 61 PDM, 600 m² ABC). The BioPiscinas water concept (§8) sizes wastewater for **20 rooms × 50 % occupancy**. Most likely interpretation: 10 *units* = 20 *rooms* (each unit a double), which would make the two consistent. **PENDING — Norbert: confirm 10 units = 20 rooms, or note any change to the programme**.

§ 11

Energy

Position: Start grid-connected → transition to fully off-grid (solar + wind + biomass).

Assets: ~300+ days of sun per year, coastal wind, an obvious south-west building aspect. The PIP shows a *central fotovoltaica* on the site plan. Infrastructure connections from Travessa da Avé Maria provide the backup grid path during build-out.

REQUIRED TO SIZE THE SYSTEM

- Q24 — Total electrical load (kW/kWh per day) at full operation
- Battery storage capacity, inverter spec, redundancy
- Phasing timeline (which buildings come online off-grid first)

- Capital and ongoing maintenance budget

Until the load calculation lands, the energy section is a principle without a plan.

§ 12

Animals

ANIMAL	NUMBERS	NOTES
Horses (Lusitano)	up to 6	Native Portuguese breed, climate-adapted. Starting from zero — infrastructure first.
Chickens	TBD	Pest management + eggs
Dogs	1+	Property security and companionship
Goats	1–2	Browsing in degraded zones
Bees	Yes	Pollination + honey
Cow	Future	If space and capacity allow

No horse sales. Revenue from the equine layer is experiential — workshops in natural horsemanship — not livestock trade.

Grazing

The pasture layer (zones 7 + 8 in the eight-zone development plan, §10) splits into three sub-types matched to the soil and water signature of each part of the lower section:

PASTURE	WHERE	CHARACTER
Dry pasture	West of the central depression	Drained, drier soils — pasture for the warm months
Wet pasture	At and around the wet depression	Groundwater-near, productive for longer in the dry season
Recovery / weed-control zone	Northern part, currently overgrown with <i>Ulex europaeus</i> , <i>Cortaderia sellowiana</i> and <i>Acacia</i>	Restoration grazing — horses as part of the invasives-control programme. Eradication first, structured pasture afterwards

Rotation moves horses between zones based on land condition. The full division design (paddock count, rotation intervals, rest periods) lands once carrying capacity is sized against climate and water data — downstream of §7 and §8.

A **round pen** is required for natural-horsemanship workshops; siting depends on soil drainage and proximity to the stables. The pasture at the south edge of the parcel gets a **willow planting** as a visual screen toward neighbours (BioPiscinas zone-plan, intervention #8).

§ 13

Plants & Food Production

Philosophy. Full organic. No synthetic fertilisers. No synthetic plant-protection products. Ever. *Non-negotiable.*

System. Permaculture-based food forest plus kitchen garden. The food forest oriented toward perennial resilience; the kitchen garden toward family food sovereignty.

Fruit trees (confirmed viable for Atlantic Portugal): lemon, orange, cherry, apple, fig, peach.

Vegetables: carrot, salad, diverse mix.

Siting. The kitchen garden (zone 5 of the eight-zone plan, §10) sits in the valley along the historic drainage ditch, on groundwater-near soils — fresh, nutrient-rich, well-watered, with minimum irrigation required. This is also the principle that governs the post-eucalyptus zone: pioneer species and soil remediation precede food-bearing planting by several seasons.

Goal. Family food sovereignty first; surplus to local community and (long-term) restaurant supply second.

§ 14

Aesthetic Direction

The visual constitution of the project lives on a Miro board curated by Norbert under the working title *taipa house / clay*. It is organised by category — **architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape, stables** — and represents the language the buildings, interiors and landscape should speak.

Visual reference (printed version): the board is interactive on the web edition of this document at enklava.co/projects/reconnecta. It contains category-organised image clusters covering architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape and stables.

Section in progress. Below: the categories that will receive their own page in the published whitepaper — one tile, one paragraph, one decision per category (what is being carried across, what is being left behind). Tiles remain as placeholders to mark the work still ahead.

ARCHITECTURE
MASS & ELEVATION
ROOFS
KITCHEN
DINING
ATELIER
SAUNA · WELLNESS
MATERIALS
INSTALLATIONS
OUTDOOR KITCHEN
LANDSCAPE
STABLES

§ 15

Economy & Funding

Revenue streams (named, not yet modelled)

STREAM	STAGE	NOTES
Hotel Rural 3★ accommodation	Near-term primary	10 units, short and longer stays
Natural-horsemanship workshops	Near-term	Norbert's core expertise — immediate asset
Ecology / permaculture workshops	Near-term	Norbert's network
Restaurant / food service	Long-term	Land-to-table, post-stabilisation
Artist residencies & cultural	Long-term	Mission, not margin
Licensing of replicable model	Aspirational	Geographic franchise

Financial position

Current revenue	Zero — fully in investment / build phase
Funding source	Norbert's personal company. No external investors. No bank financing.
Operating entity	HOME 4 LIFE LDA (Portuguese commercial Lda., NIPC 513229477) — PENDING — Q18 reconcile with nonprofit framing and with Continew GmbH (DE company named as Auftraggeber)
Build budget (next 12 months)	€300,000 – €400,000
Active costs	Architects, consultants, biologist, project management

Budget vs. scope — open tension

A single off-grid-ready accommodation unit in Portugal currently costs €60–80k. Ten units plus main house plus stables plus infrastructure plus water plus energy plus access — at credible 2026 costs — sits closer to €800k–€1m+. The €300–400k figure for the next 12 months is therefore either a phase-1 number (and the rest of the programme is on a multi-year capital plan) or scope must be staged more aggressively. Either way: an honest financial model with phasing is required before construction commitment. **PENDING — Q16, Q17**

Grants — opportunities not yet engaged

- Portugal PEPAC 2023–2027 (CAP successor): agroforestry, agrotourism, young farmers
- LIFE Programme (EU): nature and biodiversity
- EEA Grants (Norway / Iceland / Liechtenstein): conservation
- Portuguese environmental funds: habitat restoration

Insurance

Architect's professional indemnity is in place. Property, guest liability, employer liability, equine/workshop liability — none yet planned. Six horses, workshop participants, visiting children: meaningful exposure. **PENDING — Q19**

Vision: Five and Ten Years

Five years

Family home occupied. Horses on the land. Partners, friends and visitors living on-site short or medium term. Cultural activities running — artist residencies, music, gatherings. A local community hub where people from different sectors meet and connect.

Ten years

Same vision, deepened. Cycles and processes stable. Community settled. The core principle holds: *co-existing with nature, on independent food and independent energy, in collaboration with local communities and neighbours.*

Lifestyle pattern

- 6–8 months per year on the land
- Most productive shoulder seasons: February–May, September–November
- Away during winter and peak summer

Financial posture

Nonprofit framing. Self-sustaining after the investment phase. Not a profit centre. Open to biodiversity-focused conservation partners.

Reference Projects

A March 2026 review benchmarked Reconnecta against ten Portuguese precedents:

PROJECT	LUXURY	OFF-GRID	RESEARCH	COMMUNITY	EDUCATION
Tamera	—	✓	★	★	★
Quinta do Rabaçal	★	★	—	○	—
Vale das Estrelas	★	★	—	—	—
Terra Sangha	✓	✓	★	✓	✓
Terra Alta	—	✓	✓	✓	★

PROJECT	LUXURY	OFF-GRID	RESEARCH	COMMUNITY	EDUCATION
A Quinta da Lage	—	✓	—	★	✓
Vale Ondula	—	✓	✓	★	✓
Quinta do Vale	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Orange Eco Land	○	✓	—	✓	—
Tinhela610	★	✓	—	—	—
Reconnecta	★	★	★	★	★

The empty space. No single project in Portugal currently does what Reconnecta proposes. The luxury layer, the research layer, the community layer and the education layer all exist — but separately. Reconnecta sits at their intersection. That space, in the Portuguese market, is genuinely empty.

Closest references by axis: Luxury + off-grid → Quinta do Rabaçal, Vale das Estrelas, Tinhela610. Research + living lab → Tamera (water systems, 30 years of data), Terra Sangha. Community + education → Terra Alta, A Quinta da Lage, Vale Ondula.

§ 18

Values & Principles

Collaboration	The project is built, run and evolved through human partnership. Non-negotiable.
Natural alignment	Work with what is here — local conditions, local species, local community. No imposed systems.
Organic absolute	No synthetic fertilisers or plant-protection products. Ever.
Regeneration over productivity	Nonprofit framing removes profit pressure. Focus: biodiversity and ecosystem health.
Community as infrastructure	Neighbours = security network when Norbert is absent. Mutual aid. Shared machinery.
Non-dogmatic	No single -ism. Permaculture, biodynamics, organic agriculture — full deck of cards.

Non-negotiables: the land, and the approach.

Open Questions

The diagnostic captured a strong qualitative picture. The follow-up below is the minimum information needed to convert the picture into a credible roadmap. Tags: *blocking* (no design possible without) or *important* (need but parallelisable).

● Blocking — climate & geography

- Q1 Annual rainfall (mm/year) and monthly distribution
- Q4 Frost days per year, by month
- Q5 Prevailing wind directions and speeds
- Q6 Wildfire history + PMDFCI fire-risk classification

● Blocking — people & operations

- Q7 Kamila's role
- Q8 Paweł's status, scope, authority
- Q9 Operational-manager budget, salary, housing, search timeline
- Q10 Who manages during 4–6-month absences
- Q11 Labour budget beyond manager role

● Blocking — water & soil

- Q12 APA borehole licence — applied for?
- Q13 Stream summer behaviour
- Q14 Formal soil tests — commitment + target date
- Q15 Eucalyptus removal date and stump treatment

● Blocking — finance & legal

- Q16 Projected annual operating costs at full operation
- Q17 Occupancy rate and nightly-rate assumptions
- Q18 Legal structure: HOME 4 LIFE LDA (PT Lda., land-holder) vs. Continew GmbH (DE — current commissioning client of the BioPiscinas landscape study) vs. stated nonprofit framing
- Q19 Insurance — current and planned
- Q20 Lease terms for the rented 4–5 ha

● Blocking — fire & safety

- Q21 Fire management plan — firebreaks, fire-safe water reserve, emergency vehicle access
- Q22 PMDFCI high-fire-risk zone designation

● Important

- Q23 Accommodation unit detail beyond PIP — layout, materials, target price
- Q24 Total expected electrical load (kW/kWh per day)
- Q25 Sewage/wastewater plan — composting / wetland / septic mix
- Q26 Top-3 priorities for first 12 months
- Q27 Minimum viable version of the project
- Q28 Contingency if PIP delayed 12 months
- Q29 Physical work undertaken since 2019 acquisition

Of 29 original follow-up questions, the PIP package answered or partially answered 7. Sixteen blocking questions remain. A focused follow-up session with Norbert addressing Q1–Q22 unlocks roadmap drafting.

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Appendix — Wish List

Norbert's full programme, submitted 2026-03-30 (translated from Polish). Carried here intact — this is the long list, against which scope is staged.

INDEPENDENT ENERGY

Solar panels. Fireplace with water jacket. Three wells. Site-wide water installation.

HALL / WORKSHOP COMPLEX

Trampolines. Storage for excavator, tractor with front loader, mower. Hay storage. Sculpture atelier. Carpentry workshop.

BUILDINGS

Several tiny houses (accommodation). Yoga hall / multi-use space. Shared outdoor kitchen. Paddock.

ACTIVITIES & INFRASTRUCTURE

Site-wide communication. Site-wide lighting. Ski jump / jump ramp. Zip line. Treehouse. Horse trail. Entry gate as sculpture / landmark installation.

SERVICE & GUEST FACILITIES

Five-car garage. Kite equipment room (washing, drying). Outdoor hot shower. En-suite rooms with wardrobes. Multi-functional salon for concerts and performances.

MAIN HOUSE

Mosquito nets and covered porches. Large laundry near kitchen (with view, wardrobe, mangle). Wardrobe at entrance. Exercise / music room (Kamila's). Wood-burning oven plus bread oven. EMF-free zone. Brushed-oak floors.

GARDEN & PERMACULTURE

Greenhouse. Root cellar. Hidden room. Fruit trees (apple, orange, lemon, peach, fig).

ANIMALS & EQUESTRIAN

Four horses (later six). Natural shelters. Paddock and round pen. Horse trail.

OTHER ANIMALS

Chickens. Dogs. Bees.

SAUNA & WELLNESS SPA

Several natural ponds (cold and warm, varying depths). Massage room. Wood-fired sauna.

§ 21

Source Documents

The studies and filings cited throughout this whitepaper are hosted alongside it. Each link points to the original PDF as published / submitted; English translations are provided where the source is in another language.

PIP submission package — January 2026

Pre-permit information request (*Pedido de Informação Prévia*) submitted by HOME 4 LIFE LDA to Caldas da Rainha municipality. Five thematic volumes plus a single combined PDF.

VOLUME	PAGES	SIZE
PIP — all documents (combined)	—	20 MB
V1 — cadastral certificates	22	8.5 MB
V2 — project narrative + biodiversity	18	18 MB
V3 — topographic site plans (TPG Lda, 1:500)	16	15 MB

VOLUME	PAGES	SIZE
V4 — cross-sections + infrastructure	9	6.2 MB
V5 — architect renderings + site overview	2	18 MB

Landscape-planning study — June 2026 (final report)

Schwarzer & Schwarzer, *Rewilding by BioPiscinas Lda* (Aljezur). *Abschlussbericht* — final report. Commissioned by Contineu GmbH (Camille & Norbert Roztocki). Source for \$5, \$7, \$8, \$9, \$10, \$11, \$12.

DOCUMENT	FORMAT	SIZE
Landschaftsplanerische Bewertung — Abschlussbericht (DE) (authoritative source)	DOCX	7.9 MB
Landscape-Planning Assessment — EN translation (working translation)	Markdown	—

Source repository

The full source of this site — whitepaper text, landing page, build scripts, basemap data, attachments — lives at github.com/PawelSroczynski/reconnecta. Self-host instructions for `reconnecta.world` are in the repository's README.